

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Backend Engineer with 8+ years of expertise in designing and building scalable backend systems, APIs, and streaming services using Java, Spring Boot, Kafka, and cloud-native technologies. Proven track record working in agile environments to deliver high-performance solutions in Romania and Estonia. Proficient in Kubernetes, AWS, GitLab CI/CD, RESTful and GraphQL APIs. Strong system design background and integration experience across distributed services. Enthusiastic about delivering customer-centric solutions with reliability, scalability, and maintainability.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Java, Python, JavaScript
- **Backend Technologies:** Spring Boot, REST, GraphQL, Kafka, RabbitMQ
- **Cloud Platforms:** AWS (EC2, S3, Aurora, Lambda), GCP (basic exposure)
- **Containerization & Orchestration:** Docker, Kubernetes
- **DevOps & CI/CD:** GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Git
- **Databases:** MySQL, Aurora DB, PostgreSQL
- **Monitoring & Logging:** Prometheus, Grafana, ELK
- **Version Control & Tools:** Git, GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket
- **Others:** Agile, Scrum, TDD, JIRA, Confluence

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Sensidev

September 2021 – December 2024

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Designed and implemented high-performance microservices using Java and Spring Boot for large-scale data processing and user-facing APIs deployed on AWS.
- Developed and optimized Kafka-based streaming pipelines to handle real-time event processing with improved throughput and low-latency delivery.
- Deployed scalable REST and GraphQL APIs integrated with MySQL and Aurora DB to serve millions of customer transactions securely and efficiently.
- Migrated on-premise services to Kubernetes-based AWS EKS clusters, reducing deployment friction and improving system resilience.
- Led CI/CD implementation using GitLab CI and GitHub Actions, increasing release frequency by 40% through pipeline automation and improved test coverage.

- Participated in system design reviews, defined service boundaries, and ensured seamless integration across interdependent components.
- Integrated monitoring with Prometheus and Grafana, enabling proactive incident detection and reduced MTTR by over 30%.
- Collaborated closely with product teams in agile sprints, delivering features reliably while mentoring junior engineers in backend design patterns.

Software Engineer

Syscom Digital

October 2019 – August 2021

Bucharest, Romania (Remote)

- Built backend APIs using Java Spring Boot and deployed them via Docker to Kubernetes environments, ensuring cloud-native architecture alignment.
- Designed fault-tolerant Kafka consumers and producers to support business-critical campaign tracking services and reduce event loss incidents.
- Implemented complex database schemas and optimized SQL queries across MySQL and Aurora DB to boost data retrieval times by 25%.
- Integrated CI/CD pipelines using GitLab and Jenkins for multiple microservices, streamlining automated testing and deployment workflows.
- Assisted in cloud adoption by containerizing legacy apps and migrating them to AWS with improved scalability and cost efficiency.
- Contributed to API standardization across teams, facilitating improved onboarding and documentation consistency via Swagger/OpenAPI.
- Diagnosed production issues and implemented long-term fixes, achieving 99.9% uptime across managed backend services.
- Led initiatives for increasing code quality via TDD practices and peer review enforcement, reducing regression rates.

Software Developer

Soft Build

June 2016 – July 2019

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Developed and maintained enterprise backend services in Java and Spring, ensuring strict adherence to business logic and secure data flows.
- Created REST APIs serving cross-platform web apps, applying layered architecture and clean code principles to ensure maintainability.
- Conducted performance profiling of database-heavy components, resulting in a 40% improvement in query execution time.
- Implemented streaming integrations with Kafka for notification systems, enabling reliable real-time alerts to end-users.
- Integrated third-party services using OAuth2, ensuring secure token-based access and standardized user identity mapping.
- Automated deployment and rollback mechanisms using Git-based branching models and CI/CD best practices.
- Regularly collaborated with QA to define robust test cases and reduce defect leakage to production.
- Contributed to sprint planning and backlog grooming sessions, aligning development with project goals and stakeholder expectations.

Software Developer

Decima Digital

November 2015 – April 2016

Tallinn, Estonia

- Developed backend APIs using Spring Boot and JDBC for client data management systems hosted on private cloud.
- Maintained and refactored legacy codebases, introducing modularization and improving developer onboarding experience.
- Created scripts to automate batch processing and ETL operations for syncing client records across internal tools.
- Built reusable utility modules and libraries, significantly reducing boilerplate across multiple backend services.
- Worked closely with front-end developers to define API contracts and deliver seamless user interactions.
- Participated in security audits and patched backend vulnerabilities, improving system security posture.
- Performed code reviews and enforced Git commit standards across the development team.
- Delivered technical documentation for deployed modules, aiding in knowledge transfer and maintenance.

Software Developer Intern

Borna Technology

September 2014 – August 2015

Tallinn, Estonia (On-Site)

- Assisted in building REST APIs using Spring MVC and Hibernate for internal customer tracking applications.
- Developed unit and integration test suites for Java components, achieving 80%+ code coverage metrics.
- Conducted load testing and documented performance bottlenecks, supporting architectural changes for scalability.
- Learned and applied Agile methodologies including daily stand-ups and sprint retrospectives.
- Participated in early-stage design discussions and POC development, contributing innovative ideas on data access and caching.
- Collaborated with full-time engineers on code reviews, learning best practices in version control and coding standards.
- Wrote scripts for automated data validation using Python and Bash.
- Supported infrastructure setup on AWS EC2 and RDS during app deployment cycles.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- ❖ AWS Certified Developer – Associate (2023)
 - ❖ Confluent Certified Developer for Apache Kafka (2024)
 - ❖ Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 11 Developer (2022)
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PROJECTS

- ✓ **Event-Driven Notification Platform**

Developed a scalable platform using Kafka, Java Spring Boot, and AWS Lambda to handle event ingestion from microservices and push real-time user notifications. Integrated REST and GraphQL APIs for consumer apps.

- ✓ **CI/CD Optimization Suite**

Created reusable GitLab pipeline templates for microservices, covering build, test, scan, and deploy stages. Reduced manual deployment errors and cycle time across product lines.

- ✓ **Cloud Cost Optimizer Tool**

Designed a dashboard in Spring Boot and React, consuming AWS billing APIs and internal usage metrics to provide optimization suggestions and alerts for underutilized resources.